

School Support Conversation Guide

A simple guide to preparing for a meeting with your child's school. Fill in what you can; blank spaces are fine.

You don't need the right words or a finished plan. What helps most is clear examples of what you've noticed and what already works. Ideas to discuss, not demands to make.

1 What we are noticing, at school and at home

Focus, planning, transitions, noise, tests, homework, mornings, friendships. Real moments say more than labels.

2 What tends to make things harder

Times of day, kinds of tasks, busy rooms, unexpected changes, long instructions.

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3 What already helps

At home, at a previous school, with a particular teacher, from a clinician. Small things count.

4 Questions to ask

For the teacher, the year-level coordinator or the learning-support team.

- What are you noticing in class, and when does it go well?
- Which adjustments have you tried, and what happened?
- Who is the best person to keep in touch with, and how often?
- How will we know whether the support is working?

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5 Ideas to discuss

Support looks different for every student. These are starting points, not a list to insist on.

- ☐ Clearer or shorter instructions, written down
- ☐ Movement breaks or a job to do
- ☐ Flexible seating
- ☐ A quieter space for tests or focused work

- ☐ Extra time, or work broken into steps
- ☐ Help getting organised: diaries, checklists, reminders
- ☐ Warning before changes to the routine
- ☐ A regular check-in with one trusted staff member

6 What to take to the meeting

- ☐ This guide, filled in
- ☐ Any report or letter from a clinician
- ☐ A couple of recent examples of school work

- ☐ Your child's own words about what helps, if they want to share
- ☐ Your questions, and a way to take notes

7 How we will review whether support is working

Agree a date to check in, and what “working” would look like: calmer mornings, finished tasks, fewer notes home, a happier child.

Notes from the meeting